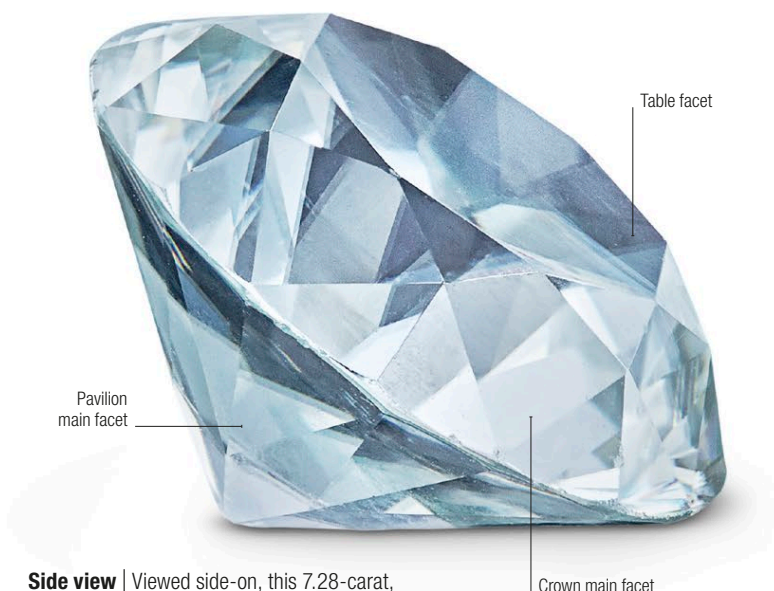
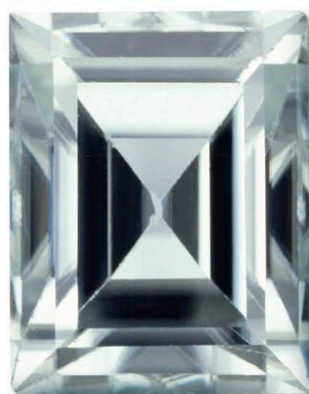




Side view | Viewed side-on, this 7.28-carat, white specimen exhibits a classic brilliant cut, exposing the many different facets and revealing the mineral's refractive quality.



Champagne colour | The soft colour of this brilliant-cut gem is highly unusual, and is most likely an unexpected response to heat treatment.



Changing colour | Not all heat-treated brown zircons turn a brilliant dark blue – some, like this faceted example, turn a very pleasing, almost transparent, mid-blue.



Blue gems | This group of fine blue, step-cut zircons with deep pavilions displays the blue colour characteristic of heat treatment.



Natural state | Some zircons do not go through heat treatment. This beautiful emerald-cut stone has been kept in its natural reddish-brown state.

Settings

White gold setting

Blue zircon



Blue zircon ring | Crafted by jewellery designer Karina Brez, this ring is based around a 10.60-carat blue zircon, set in white gold with white diamonds.



Openwork brooch | A cluster of circular-cut, pale blue zircons sit at the centre of this scrolling gold brooch, with ruby and diamond highlights.



Stunning earrings | Set in white gold, the vibrant blue zircons in these attractive earrings are perfectly complemented by the yellow sapphires at the top of each.

Clear zircon resembles diamond, but the two can be distinguished: zircon exhibits double refraction, while diamond does not